

Investment Committee Simulation

Student roadmap, requirements, and approval-gate checklists

Use this PDF to organize your committee's work without scrolling through the website. Canvas remains the authority for due dates, points, and submission mechanics.

What BUS331 provides - and what your committee creates

BUS331 provides structured Excel workbooks and client data. Your committee completes the analysis, reaches its own conclusions, and creates its own final PowerPoint presentation.

Before you begin

- [] Confirm the four committee roles and your three assigned clients.
- [] Create a shared team workspace and agree on a file-naming system.
- [] Read the current phase checklist together before beginning work.
- [] Schedule a short committee meeting before each approval gate.

Phase 1 - Frame the Mandate

Establish one defensible 12-month market view and convert each assigned client profile into an approved investment mandate.

Do this in order

1. Set roles, client assignments, and the team workspace.
2. Complete the detailed macro analysis in the provided workbook: review historical evidence, form a human-first interpretation, and document sources.
3. Compare the committee view with FactSet and/or FRED evidence, then create bull, base, and bear scenarios with probabilities totaling 100%.
4. Analyze each client's goals, constraints, risk, and unresolved information gaps.
5. Translate the macro outlook into a client-specific mandate, including return target, risk limit, and drawdown tripwire.
6. Hold Gate 1: challenge the evidence, vote, and record required revisions before any portfolio construction begins.

Definition of done

[] The macro workbook documents historical analysis, consensus comparison, and weighted bull, base, and bear scenarios.

[] Each client has objectives, RRTTLLU constraints, a return target, risk limit, drawdown tripwire, and identified information gaps.

[] The committee can explain how its macro outlook changes each client mandate.

[] All four members have recorded the Gate 1 vote and any revision actions.

Required evidence

- Human-first five-year macro read with source dates
- FactSet/FRED consensus comparison and team forecast
- Bull/base/bear scenarios with probabilities totaling 100%
- RRTTLLU analysis for all three assigned clients
- Return target, maximum volatility, and drawdown tripwire for each client
- Analyst Decision Log showing initial judgment, committee challenge, verification, final reasoning, and downstream guardrail
- Phase 1 decision record signed by all four members

Team deliverables

- Completed macro starter workbook
- Completed Analyst Decision Log for all three assigned clients
- Three completed client IPS documents
- One-page committee mandate memo
- Phase 1 decision record

Client-discovery activity

First observe the instructor-led practice interview. Then open only your team's role-play page. For each assigned client, one designated member receives a sealed client card while the other members ask their own neutral questions. Rotate the client role across the three cases.

The client reveals only what the sealed card establishes. If a fact is not established, record an information gap. After each interview, write a concise summary, the provisional guardrails, and the downstream decision each guardrail could affect in the Analyst Decision Log. No AI prompt or student AI account is required for this activity.

Canvas submission check

- [] Scenario probabilities total 100% and every macro claim has a source and as-of date.
- [] Each client has an objective, RRTTLLU constraints, return target, volatility limit, drawdown tripwire, and unresolved information gaps.
- [] The Decision Record shows initial judgment, committee challenge, human verification, final reasoning, downstream guardrail, owner, and peer reviewer.
- [] All four members recorded the Phase 1 vote and any revision action.

Phase 2 - Build & Challenge

Translate the Phase 1 view into capital-market expectations, construct client portfolios, select securities, design risk mitigation, and challenge each recommendation under stress.

Do this in order

1. Reopen the approved client mandate before researching investments.
2. Use the structured workbooks to develop capital-market expectations and draft allocations.
3. Research and compare candidate bonds, mutual funds, and ETFs against client guardrails.
4. Build the proposed portfolios, identify the purpose of every holding, and submit the locked baseline snapshot before the Scenario Reveal.
5. After the instructor releases the client-specific Scenario Reveal, apply its exact inputs, identify the client consequence, correct the required breach, and re-test.
6. Hold Gate 2: approve, revise, or reject each client portfolio and record the decision.

Definition of done

- [] Each client portfolio traces back to an approved mandate and has a stated purpose for every holding.
- [] Evidence supports the material investment choices and their client fit.
- [] The baseline snapshot was submitted before the Scenario Reveal; each revealed-scenario breach has a documented corrective trade, trade-off, and full re-test.
- [] All four members have recorded the Gate 2 vote and any revision actions.

Required evidence

- Base and bear CME inputs with cited rationale
- Solver output and constraint checks for each client
- Bond comparison with yield, return drivers, duration, credit quality, liquidity, taxes, client fit, and sources
- Mutual-fund and ETF comparison with objective, benchmark/style, holdings, costs, liquidity, taxes, performance context, client fit, and sources
- Issuer Reality Check for every direct bond or equity exposure and the most material relevant issuer/holding within each selected fund or ETF
- Candidate decision records showing the provisional judgment, AI challenge, verification, final select/reject decision, and portfolio role
- FactSet Research and Evidence Log for every recommended security and material portfolio-risk input
- Integrated allocation with a purpose, owner, Phase 1 guardrail, risk contribution, and monitoring trigger for every holding
- Risk-mitigation comparison showing cost and trade-offs
- Locked baseline snapshot and instructor-issued Scenario Reveal log for every client
- Full IPS compliance scorecard and Scenario Reveal result against each approved tripwire and relevant constraint
- Before/after record, trade-off, and full re-test for every corrective trade
- AI audit entries linked to human verification
- Phase 2 decision record signed by all four members

Team deliverables

- Completed CME workbook
- Completed bond, mutual-fund, and ETF analysis and selection record
- Baseline snapshot plus completed Scenario Reveal, remediation, IPS compliance, and re-test record
- Phase 2 decision record with client-by-client votes

Worksheet research guide

Before you select or reject a candidate, open the Research Guide tab in the security-selection workbook. The workbook tells you what to investigate for direct bonds, equities, mutual funds, and ETFs; your committee supplies the research, calculations, judgment, and decision.

For each serious candidate, record the client need and Phase 1 guardrail, comparable source and as-of date, instrument-specific research, costs, liquidity, taxes, diversification or overlap, base and bear-case implications, a verified AI challenge if used, the final Select/Modify/Reject conclusion, and a monitoring trigger.

Complete the Issuer Reality Check for every required direct or look-through exposure and the FactSet Research and Evidence Log for every recommendation and material portfolio-risk input.

Scenario Reveal and required remediation

First submit the baseline allocation, IPS scorecard, and initial stress result at the instructor-designated checkpoint. Keep that baseline record unchanged after the Scenario Reveal is released.

After release, record the packet ID, date, named client condition tested, and exact inputs in the Scenario Reveal workbook tab. Apply the released inputs without changing the client mandate or tripwire; quantify the percentage and dollar impact and identify the exposed client goal or constraint.

For every Breach, make a real security, sleeve, or weight change, explain the trade-off, and re-run the complete scenario and IPS scorecard. If a released case unexpectedly passes, report it to the instructor rather than using the result to skip the checkpoint.

Canvas submission check

☐ Every recommended bond, mutual fund, and ETF passed a documented candidate comparison and client guardrail check.

☐ Issuer Reality Checks and licensed-evidence references cover every required direct and look-through exposure.

☐ The baseline snapshot was submitted before the Scenario Reveal; every client allocation totals 100%, all IPS objectives and constraints were re-tested, and every revealed breach has a corrective trade and full re-test.

☐ All four members recorded the Phase 2 vote and can identify the evidence they own and reviewed.

Phase 3 - Defend the Recommendation

Integrate the committee's work into a concise decision package and defend the client recommendations before an investment-committee panel.

Do this in order

1. Convert approved analysis into a clear committee recommendation for each client.
2. Create the decision memo and technical evidence package.
3. Design and build the committee's own visual PowerPoint presentation.
4. Rehearse cross-functional questions and the strongest trade-offs.
5. Hold Gate 3, submit the required package in Canvas, and defend the recommendation.

Definition of done

- [] The memo, evidence package, and presentation tell one consistent recommendation story.
- [] A reviewer can trace each major claim to evidence.
- [] Every member has rehearsed and can defend both owned work and the integrated decision.
- [] The team has checked Canvas for the correct required files and deadline.

Required evidence

- Executive recommendation and decision memo
- Technical exhibit book linking macro, mandate, allocation, securities, and risk
- Client-specific recommendation for all three assigned clients
- Final decision record with vote, reservations, and implementation actions
- Visual oral presentation with balanced speaking time
- Cross-functional Q&A preparation

Team deliverables

- Final committee decision memo
- Technical exhibit book or dossier
- Oral presentation
- Final decision record and AI audit appendix

Canvas submission check

- [] The memo, dossier, presentation, and decision record state the same allocations, securities, and monitoring actions.
- [] Every recommendation traces backward to a Phase 1 client guardrail and forward to a monitoring trigger.
- [] Every material number has a source, definition, unit, as-of date, interpretation, and limitation.
- [] Each member can defend owned work and answer questions outside that workstream during the scheduled oral defense.

Committee roles and operating protocol

Roles identify the lead for a workstream. All four members review the full evidence package, vote at every gate, and prepare to defend the complete recommendation.

Client and Macro Strategist

Own client discovery, the 12-month market view, IPS objectives and constraints, and the handoff from client needs to investment criteria.

Fixed-Income Analyst

Own the income, capital-preservation, maturity, duration, credit-quality, liquidity, and tax questions that shape the fixed-income sleeve.

Fund and ETF Analyst

Own pooled-vehicle due diligence, diversification, benchmark fit, fees, liquidity, tax considerations, and active-versus-passive implementation.

Portfolio Manager and Risk Analyst

Own portfolio integration, risk capacity versus willingness, the drawdown tripwire, decision-log quality, stress testing, and mandate-breach escalation.

AI rules of engagement

Permitted: Logic, debugging & challenge - Use AI to explain formulas, test reasoning, generate counterarguments, or surface missing risks.

Verify before use: Summaries, scenarios & estimates - Cross-check every factual claim and number against FactSet, FRED, SEC filings, or the team's workbook.

Not acceptable: Unverified decisions - Do not submit AI-generated allocations, risk metrics, citations, or client recommendations without human verification.